



Using Coding Agents in Noteable with ELM API Keys

Guidance for University of Edinburgh staff and students

AY 2026/27

Overview

University of Edinburgh staff and students can use supported coding agents in Noteable with an API key obtained through EDINA's ELM® service.

Coding agents are AI-powered tools that can assist with programming tasks in a Noteable workspace. Depending on the tool, configuration and permissions, they may help users to write, explain, debug, test and refactor code; create or edit files; work with notebooks and scripts; and carry out multi-step programming tasks.

Noteable provides a managed, containerised environment for teaching, learning and exploratory programming. Coding agents run through the Terminal within the Noteable workspace and may be able to work with files, scripts and notebooks available in that environment.

For lecturers that do not wish to make coding agents available for their course/s, these can be disabled at institutional or course level.

Supported coding agents

As of August 2026 the following coding agents are supported in Noteable:

- **Claude**
- **Codex**
- **OpenCode**

These tools are accessed through the Terminal in your Noteable environment.

University of Edinburgh users can request an ELM API key to use in Noteable. This can be used with compatible coding-agent workflows.

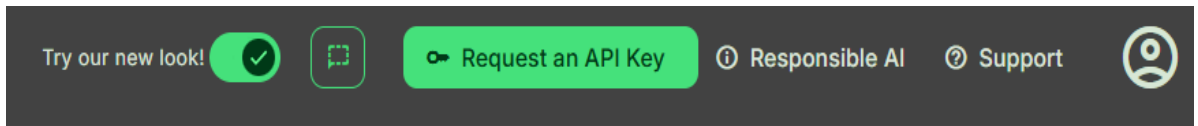
ELM may make additional models and access options available in future. Any changes will be communicated through relevant service channels.

Before using a coding agent for teaching or coursework, please test the relevant tool and authentication method in your chosen Noteable environment.

Requesting an ELM API key

To use a supported coding agent, you will need an ELM API key.

1. Sign in to ELM (www.elm.edina.ac.uk).
2. Select **Request API key** in the top-right corner of the page.



3. Follow the on-screen process to request your key.
4. Once issued, you can configure the key to use coding agents through the Terminal in Noteable.

Keep your API key secure. Do not share it, upload it to notebooks or repositories, or include it in publicly accessible files.

What is a coding agent?

A coding agent is different from a general chatbot or standard large language model interface.

A general-purpose AI tool commonly responds to questions in a chat interface. A coding agent can also work more directly with code, files and terminal commands in a workspace.

Depending on the coding agent and its configuration, it may be able to:

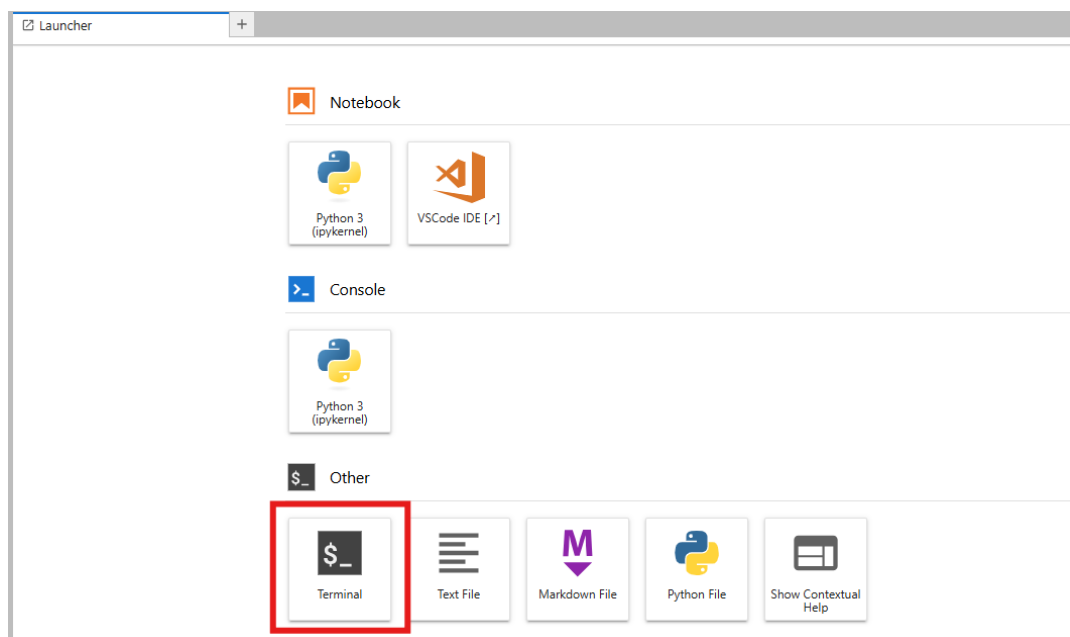
- read files in your Noteable workspace;
- suggest, create or edit code;
- explain code and programming concepts;
- identify and help debug errors;
- suggest or run terminal commands;
- create tests;
- refactor code;
- assist with notebooks, R scripts and Python scripts; and
- support multi-step programming tasks.

The user remains responsible for checking and approving any actions, code or files produced by a coding agent.

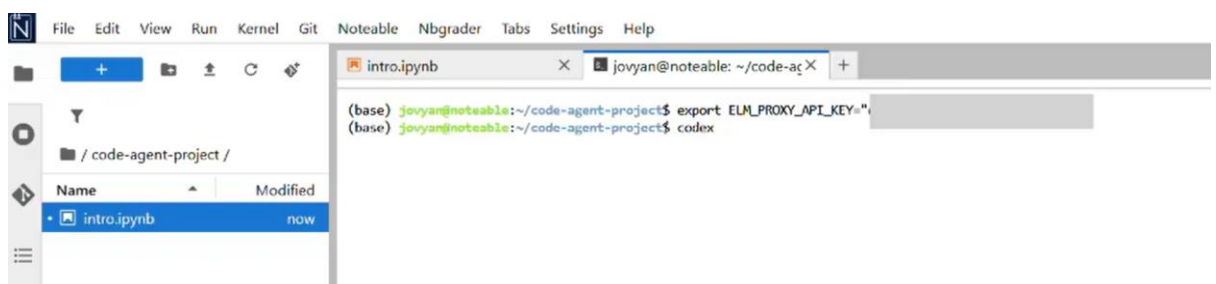
Accessing coding agents in Noteable

JupyterLab

1. Launch your preferred JupyterLab-based Noteable notebook environment.
2. Open a Terminal from the JupyterLab launcher.



3. Input your ELM API Key into the Terminal:



4. You can write prompts and run relevant commands, for example:

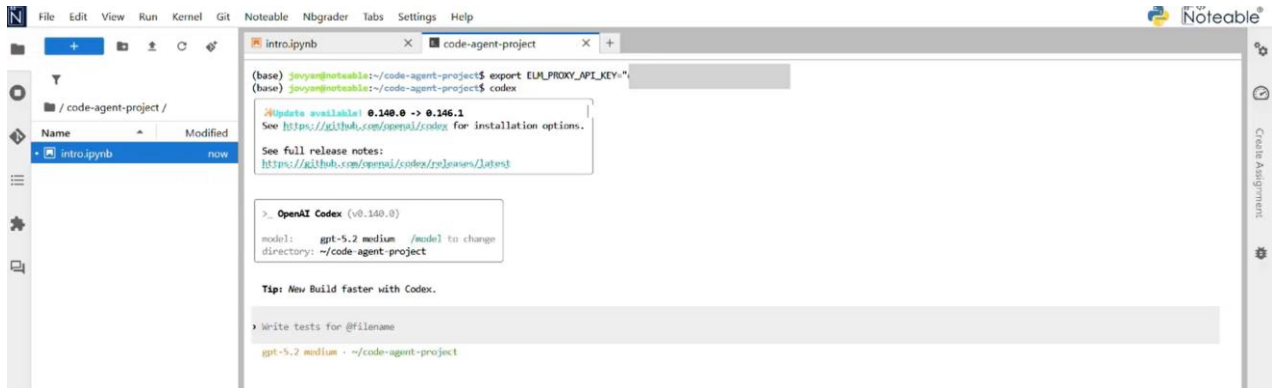
claude --help

codex --help

opencode --help

'codex' will start the codex interactive session, while

‘codex --help’ displays available commands and usage options.



You can use the text box in the Terminal to write your prompts.

Video: setting up ELM API key in JupyterLab:



RStudio

1. Launch your Noteable RStudio session.
2. Open the **Terminal** pane.
3. Run the relevant command, for example:

claude --help
codex --help
opencode --help

The agents operate within your Noteable container environment and can assist with code, scripts, notebooks and files available in that workspace.

Before using coding agents

Please consider the requirements of your course, research activity or assessment, including:

- Follow any course or School guidance on permitted AI use.
- Do not use coding agents in assessed work where this is not permitted.
- Declare or acknowledge AI assistance where required.
- Review all generated code and outputs before using them.
- Do not include sensitive, confidential, personal or restricted data in prompts unless this is explicitly permitted under the relevant University guidance.

Support

For help with Noteable access or technical issues, use the [Noteable contact form](#)

When reporting an issue, include the notebook environment, coding agent, command used, any error message, and steps to reproduce the problem.